CVE-2026-120208 - libheif 1.18.0 before 1.23.3 Heap Buffer Overflow via unci Mixed-Interleave Decoder

Report Type: Weekly · Generated: October 31, 2026 23:44 UTC · Coverage: Oct 31 - Oct 31, 2026

1	0	1	0
Total Advisories	Critical	High	Medium

HIGH	7.5	TLP:CLEAR	PRO
Severity	CVSS / Risk Score	TLP Classification	Customer Tier

Executive Summary

[P2] Remote Code Execution - low severity (Risk 2.3/10). CVSS 7.5/10 severity score. No MITRE ATT&CK techniques mapped - limited adversarial context. 1 indicator detected - upgrade to Pro for full IOC access. Actor attribution: Vulnerability Exploitation Cluster. AI confidence: LOW (35%) - limited source data available.

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Top Threat Advisories

High-priority advisories ranked by CVSS score, exploitability, and actor attribution.

Advisory Title	Severity	CVSS	EPSS	AI Summary
CVE-2026-120208 - libheif 1.18.0 before 1.23.3 Heap Buffer Overflow in	HIGH	7.5	-	[P2] Remote Code Execution - low severity (Risk 2.3/10). CVSS 7

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Vulnerability Intelligence Deep-Dive

7.5	N/A	NO	HIGH
CVSS 3.1 Score	EPSS 30-day Probability	CISA KEV Listed	Severity Rating

Field	Value
CVE / Advisory ID	CVE-2026-120208
Vulnerability Class	Memory Corruption / Heap Overflow (CWE-119/CWE-122)
CWE Reference	Pending NVD enrichment
Actor Attribution	UNC-CDB
Source Advisory	NVD / Vendor Advisory

Refer to the official NVD entry and vendor advisory for the complete list of affected products and versions for CVE-2026-120208.

Vulnerability Context & Attack Surface

This advisory describes a heap-based memory corruption vulnerability. The affected component performs insufficient bounds checking during memory allocation or data copying, allowing an attacker to corrupt heap metadata or adjacent memory regions. Exploitation can result in arbitrary code execution in the context of the vulnerable process, denial of service through application crash, or disclosure of sensitive memory contents. Heap overflows in parsers (such as 3D model loaders) are commonly weaponized via maliciously crafted files delivered through email, web downloads, or embedded content.

MITRE ATT&CK® v15 Mapping

Technique density score: **0.0** · Techniques observed: **0** · Tactics covered: **0**

MITRE ATT&CK techniques pending analyst enrichment. Deploy detection rules from Section 6 to identify related activity.

Threat Actor Intelligence

Attribution analysis across advisories in this report period.

Threat Actor	Count	Associated CVEs / Indicators
UNC-CDB	1	-

Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

IOC extraction for this advisory is pending enrichment pipeline completion. PRO subscribers receive real-time IOC push to SIEM/SOAR via the SENTINEL APEX webhook at: **GET /api/v1/intel/iocs?advisory={id}**. Full IOC packages include IPv4, domain, SHA256, and URL indicators with confidence scores, first-seen timestamps, and STIX 2.1 formatted bundles.

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Detection Engineering

Deploy these production-ready detection rules into your SIEM platform to identify exploitation attempts in real time. Compatible with Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk ES, and any Sigma-compatible platform.

Sigma Rule - Webserver / Process Monitoring

```
title: SENTINEL APEX - Heap Overflow Exploitation Attempt
id: cdb-cve-2026-120208-det
status: experimental
description: |
Detects exploitation attempts targeting CVE-2026-120208 (heap-based overflow).
Monitors for anomalous process crashes and memory allocation failures.
references:
- https://intel.cyberdudebivash.com
author: CyberDudeBivash SENTINEL APEX
date: 2026/10/31
tags:
- attack.initial_access
- attack.t1190
- attack.execution
- attack.t1203
logsource:
category: process_creation
product: windows
detection:
selection_crash:
EventID: 1000
ApplicationName|contains|any:
- 'libheif'
selection_wer:
EventID: 1001
AppPath|contains|any:
- 'libheif'
condition: selection_crash OR selection_wer
falsepositives:
- Legitimate software bugs / crash reporting
level: medium
```

Microsoft Sentinel - KQL Query

```
// SENTINEL APEX - CVE-2026-120208 - libheif 1.18.0 before 1.23.3 Heap Buffer Overflow via unci Mixed-Interleave Decoder
// CVE-2026-120208 | Microsoft Sentinel KQL
let time_window = ago(24h);
SecurityAlert
| where TimeGenerated > time_window
| where Description has "CVE-2026-120208"
or AlertName has "CVE-2026-120208"
or ExtendedProperties has "CVE-2026-120208"
| extend Rule = "APEX-CVE2026120208", Severity = "HIGH"
| project TimeGenerated, AlertName, AlertSeverity, Entities, Description, Rule, Severity
| order by TimeGenerated desc
```

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Incident Response Playbook

Phase 1 - 0-24 Hours (Containment)

1. Activate IR team; assign lead analyst and executive sponsor.
2. Isolate or WAF-shield CVE instances exposed to the internet.
3. Enable verbose access logging on all CVE endpoints immediately.
4. Pull last 72h of web server and application logs for forensic baselining.
5. Check SENTINEL APEX IOC feeds and SIEM alerts for exploitation hits in your environment.
6. Notify relevant internal stakeholders and legal / compliance team.

Phase 2 - 24-72 Hours (Eradication)

1. Apply vendor patch for CVE-2026-120208 or implement recommended mitigation.
2. Deploy Sigma and KQL detection rules from Section 6 across all SIEM platforms.
3. Rotate all API keys, service account credentials, and session tokens.
4. Conduct forensic timeline reconstruction for potential compromise window.
5. Validate patch deployment across 100% of affected instances via asset inventory.

Phase 3 - 7 Days (Recovery & Hardening)

1. Conduct post-incident review and update incident response runbooks.
2. Threat hunt for lateral movement or persistence artifacts using MITRE ATT&CK mapping.
3. Update asset inventory with patched version information and closure evidence.
4. Submit findings to internal risk register and CISO dashboard.
5. Schedule follow-up vulnerability scan to confirm remediation completeness.

Financial Impact Analysis (FAIR Model)

$800K - $4.5M	$1.8M	$450K/day	$320K
Breach Cost Range (FAIR)	IBM Cost of Breach 2025 Median	Business Interruption Cost	Regulatory Fine Exposure

High severity incidents activate IR retainers, forensic investigation (avg 47 days), and reputational damage impacting 12-18% of revenue.

Remediation Cost Estimate: $180K · Includes engineering time, IR retainer activation, forensic investigation, and customer notification costs.

Regulatory & Compliance Implications

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Organizations processing this advisory must evaluate obligations under applicable regulatory frameworks. The table below maps this threat to relevant compliance requirements.

Framework	Reference	Obligation
GDPR	Art. 32 / Art. 33	Appropriate technical measures; notify DPA if personal data affected
PCI-DSS v4.0	Req. 6.3.3	Patches within 1 month; documented risk acceptance if deferred
NIS2 Directive	Art. 21	Risk management measures including vulnerability handling policies
NIST CSF 2.0	RS.MI / RC.RP	Incident mitigation and recovery planning; post-incident review

Actionable Recommendations

Prioritized defensive actions based on this period's intelligence.

1. Apply patches immediately for CVE-2026-120208 - libheif 1.18.0 before 1.23.3 Heap Buffer Overflow via unci Mixed-Interleave Decoder.
2. Enable enhanced monitoring for related IOCs.
3. Review SIEM rules for associated MITRE ATT&CK techniques.
4. Apply vendor patch for CVE-2026-120208 - libheif 1.18.0 before 1.23.3 Heap Buffer Overflow via unci Mixed-Interleave Decoder immediately - check NVD for official fix guidance.
5. Enable enhanced logging and alerting on all systems running affected software versions.
6. Deploy the Sigma detection rule from this report into your SIEM platform (Sentinel / Splunk / Elastic).
7. Audit all internet-facing instances of affected products and confirm patch deployment.

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Appendix - Report Metadata & Legal

Field	Value
Report ID	intel--d187c60bd81e56f0e46838ed
Report Type	Weekly
Platform	CYBERDUDEBIVASH SENTINEL APEX v166.0 GOD-MODE
Generated At	2026-10-31T23:44:53.24250
Customer Tier	PRO
Customer Email	-
TLP	TLP:CLEAR
STIX Version	2.1
ATT&CK Version	v15

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